EMBERCITY

https://youtu.be/PE5N1TDyXgI

STEEL RUINS TALISMAN SUBJUGATION

GAME INTRODUCTION

Step into a once-thriving metropolis now reduced to a desolate, vegetation-choked wasteland, where nature has reclaimed every street and skyscraper from the ruins of human civilization. In this game that fuses post-apocalyptic survival grit with time-honored Chinese exorcism lore, your mission is twofold: scavenge for the mysterious, glowing celestial orbs hidden in the darkest corners of the city, and wield a sacred demon-subduing pestle to banish the hordes of malevolent fiends that roam the overgrown ruins.

Drawing visual inspiration from The Last of Us's iconic overgrown urban decay, After Earth's hauntingly silent, civilization-fallen ambiance, and A Writer's Odyssey's colossal, myth-steeped boss design, the game crafts a uniquely immersive world where every shadow hides a threat, and every orb you collect boosts your ability to stand against the darkness. As you venture deeper into the heart of the ruined city, you'll uncover fragments of the world's lost history, and ultimately face off against a towering, terrifying final boss—one whose grotesque, awe-inspiring form embodies the very essence of the chaos that has befallen this once-great land.

Main Art reference：The Last of Us

This game's visual and monster design draws core inspiration from three iconic works: The Last of Us lays the foundation with its overgrown, dilapidated urban landscapes that perfectly capture the vibe of a vegetation-choked post-apocalyptic city; After Earth contributes the desolate, silent ambiance of a once-thriving civilization reclaimed by nature; and A Writer's Odyssey serves as the blueprint for the game's colossal, terrifying final boss, infusing it with the grand, mythical traits of Chinese fantasy fiends. Together, these influences forge a distinct aesthetic that fuses doomsday grit with traditional exorcism-themed flair.

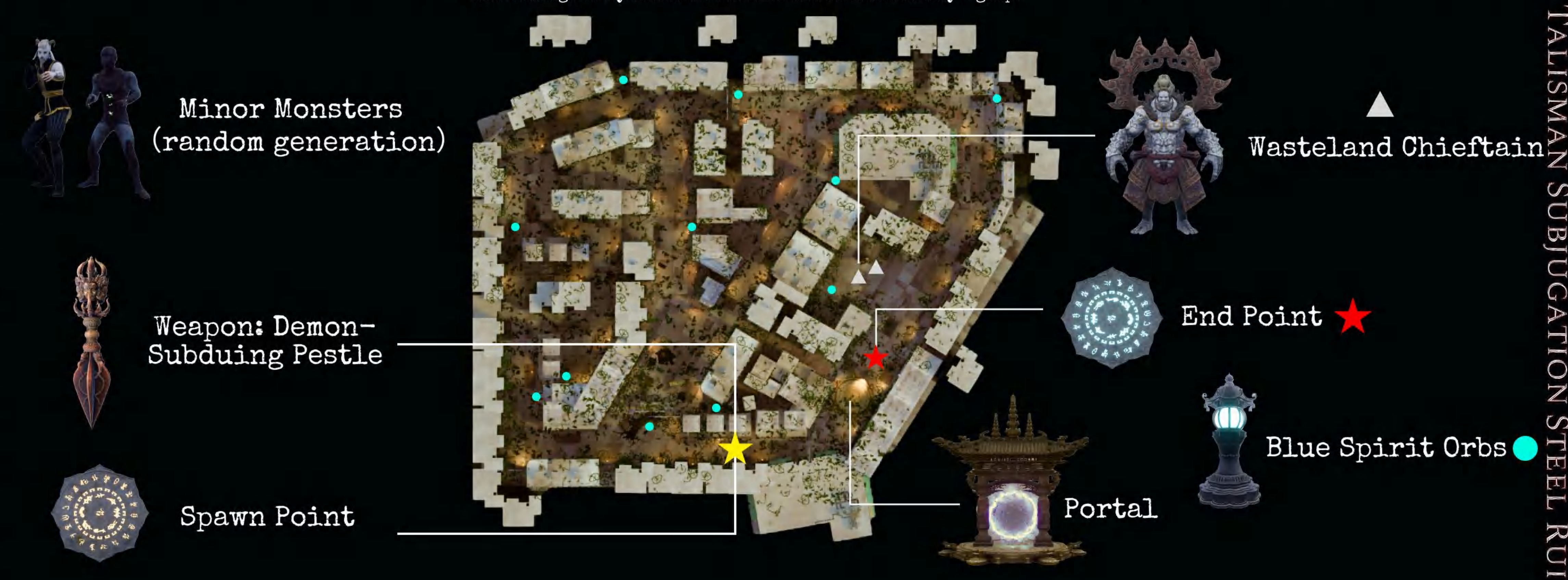
Monster Reference：After Earth 、 A Writer's Odyssey

Drawing dual inspiration from After Earth and A Writer's Odyssey, this game blends the desolate, nature-reclaimed ambiance of a long-abandoned civilization with the imposing, myth-tinged design of a colossal, menacing final boss—merging post-apocalyptic visual grit with the striking flair of Chinese fantasy to craft a unique world of urban wasteland exorcism.

GAMEPLAY & MAP OVERVIEW

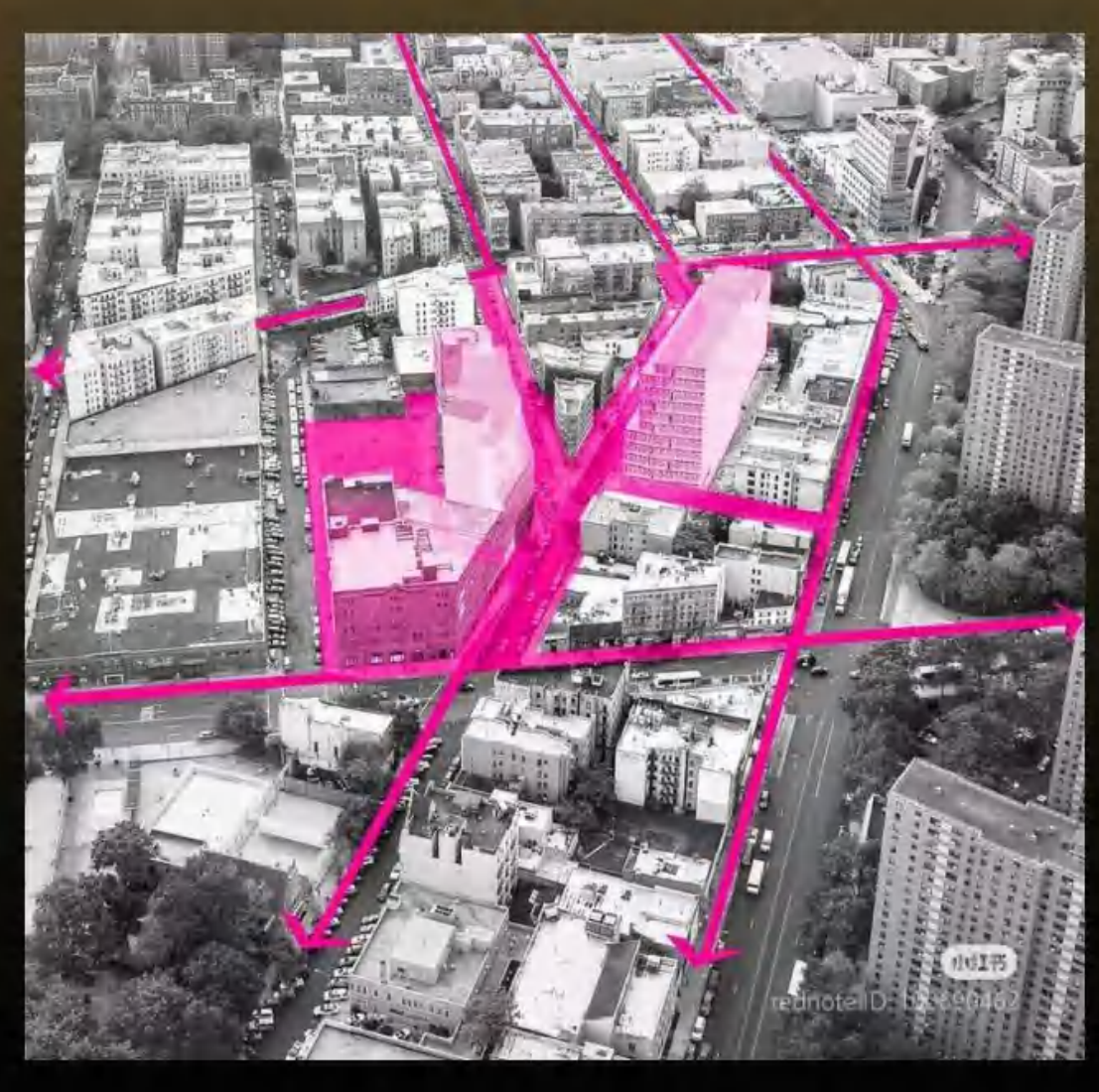
Step into the fog-shrouded abandoned Hong Kong city, where rusted buildings are overgrown with vines and weeds have swallowed up the streets of the past — a survival exploration adventure unfolds here. Your core objective is to scour every corner of the city, collect all the blue spirit orbs to activate the portal, and complete the escape challenge.

The game features a non-linear map design. You can freely navigate through vine-entwined narrow alleys and dilapidated buildings blanketed in weeds, forging your own exploration path. Along the way, various mutated enemies will ambush you from the shadows. You need to flexibly switch between dodging and counterattacking strategies to break through obstacles in the tug-of-war between offense and defense. Collecting each spirit orb is a crucial step toward victory; only with both wisdom and courage can you break free from the abandoned city's grip.



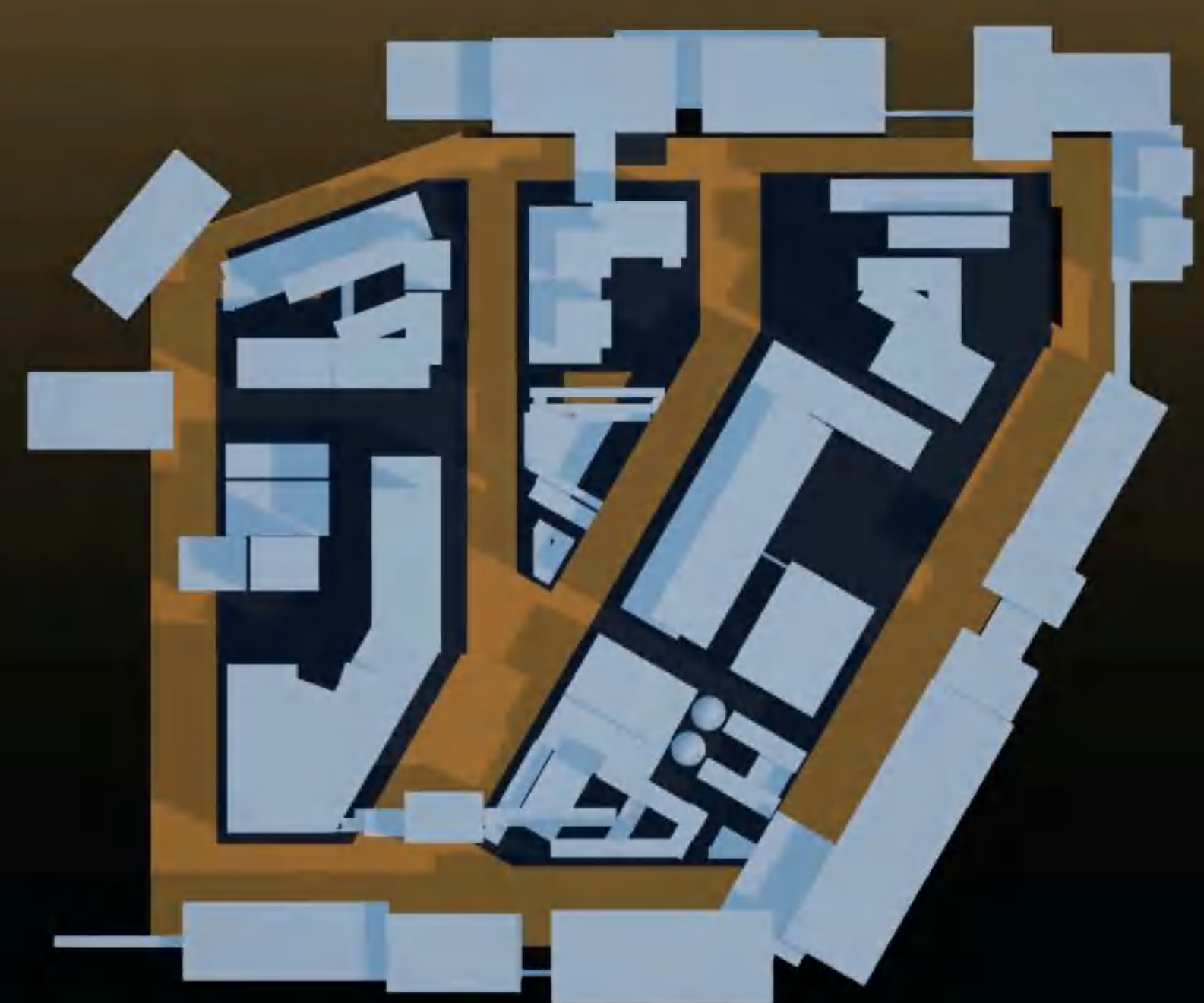
LEVEL DESIGN

City Reference

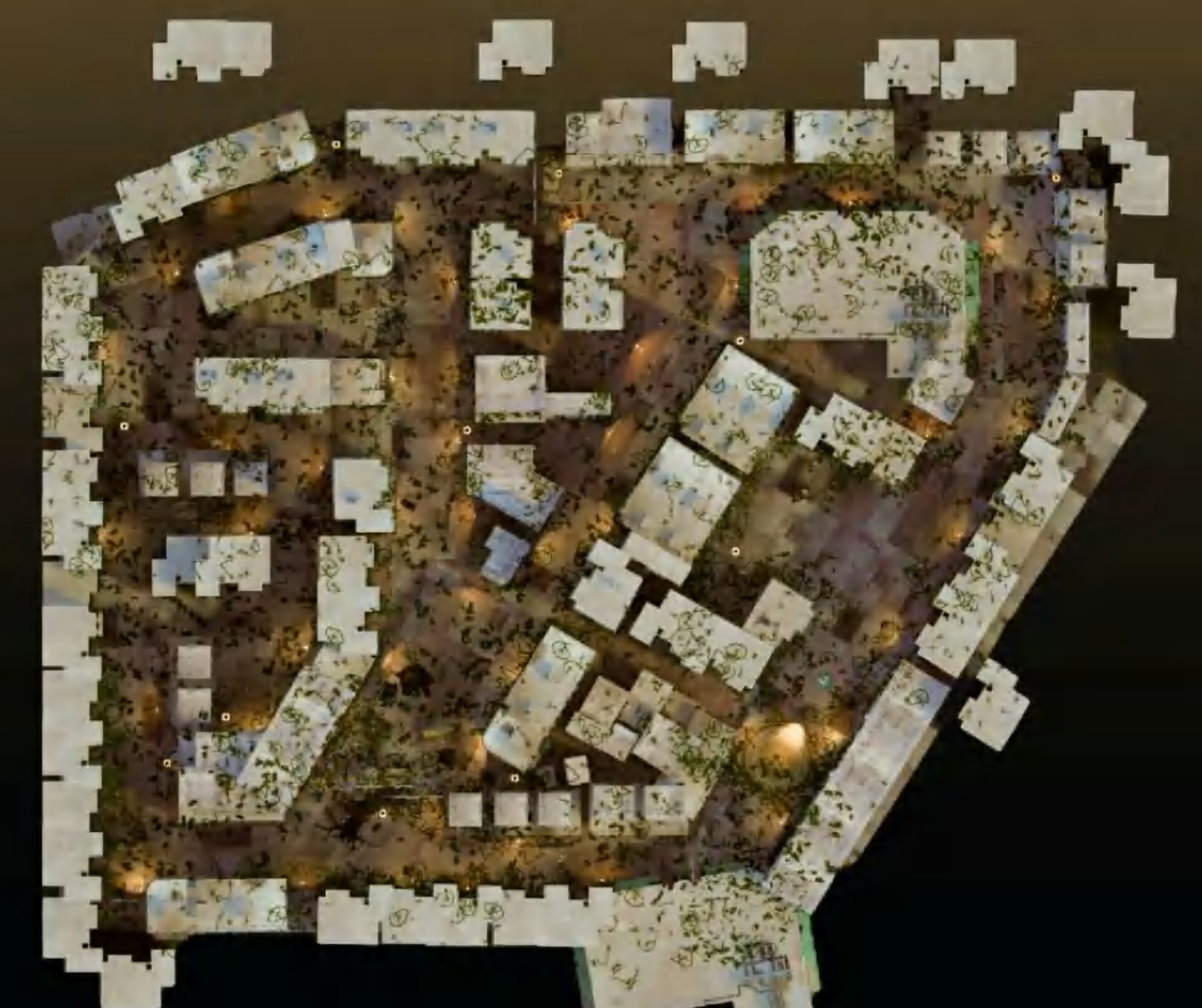


This urban texture map was discovered by chance while I was browsing reference materials. Its crisscrossing block layout and highly layered spatial structure immediately caught my attention. This dense, exploration-rich urban fabric perfectly aligned with the core experience of the game's "foggy ruins" map, so it became the foundational blueprint for the entire layout

Block out



Final Set



After finalizing the spatial layout in the basic blockout phase, I refined the details step by step: overgrown vines were added to building facades and street gaps to emphasize the sense of decay, rusty street lamps, broken signs, and other scene props were introduced to enhance narrative immersion, the ground texture was upgraded with uneven, damaged surfaces and scattered weeds to optimize spatial guidance during movement, and through weathering textures and layered lighting, the final scene emerged as a doomsday ruin that balances both functionality and atmospheric depth.

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SCENE DETAILS & GRAY BOX

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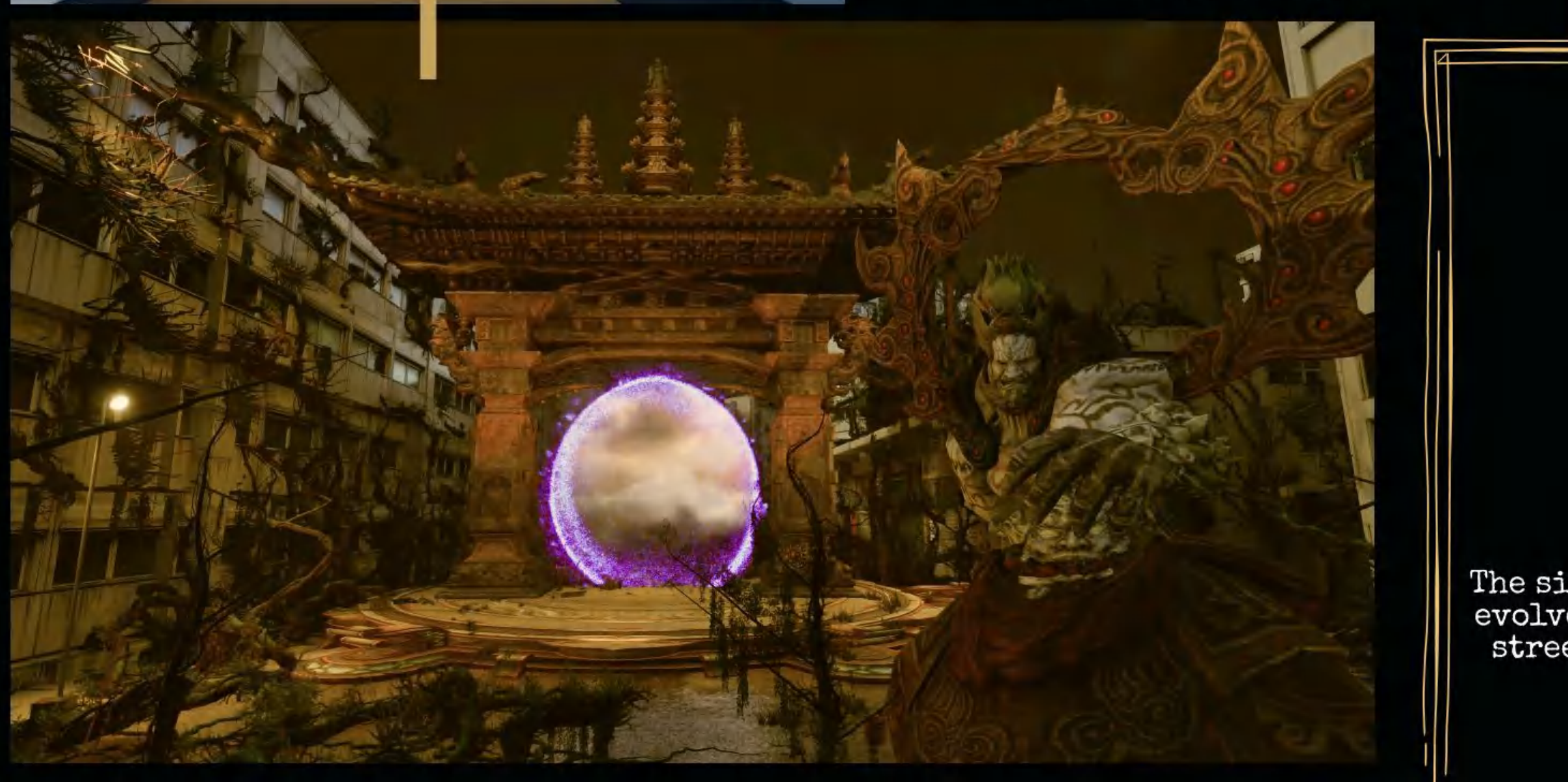
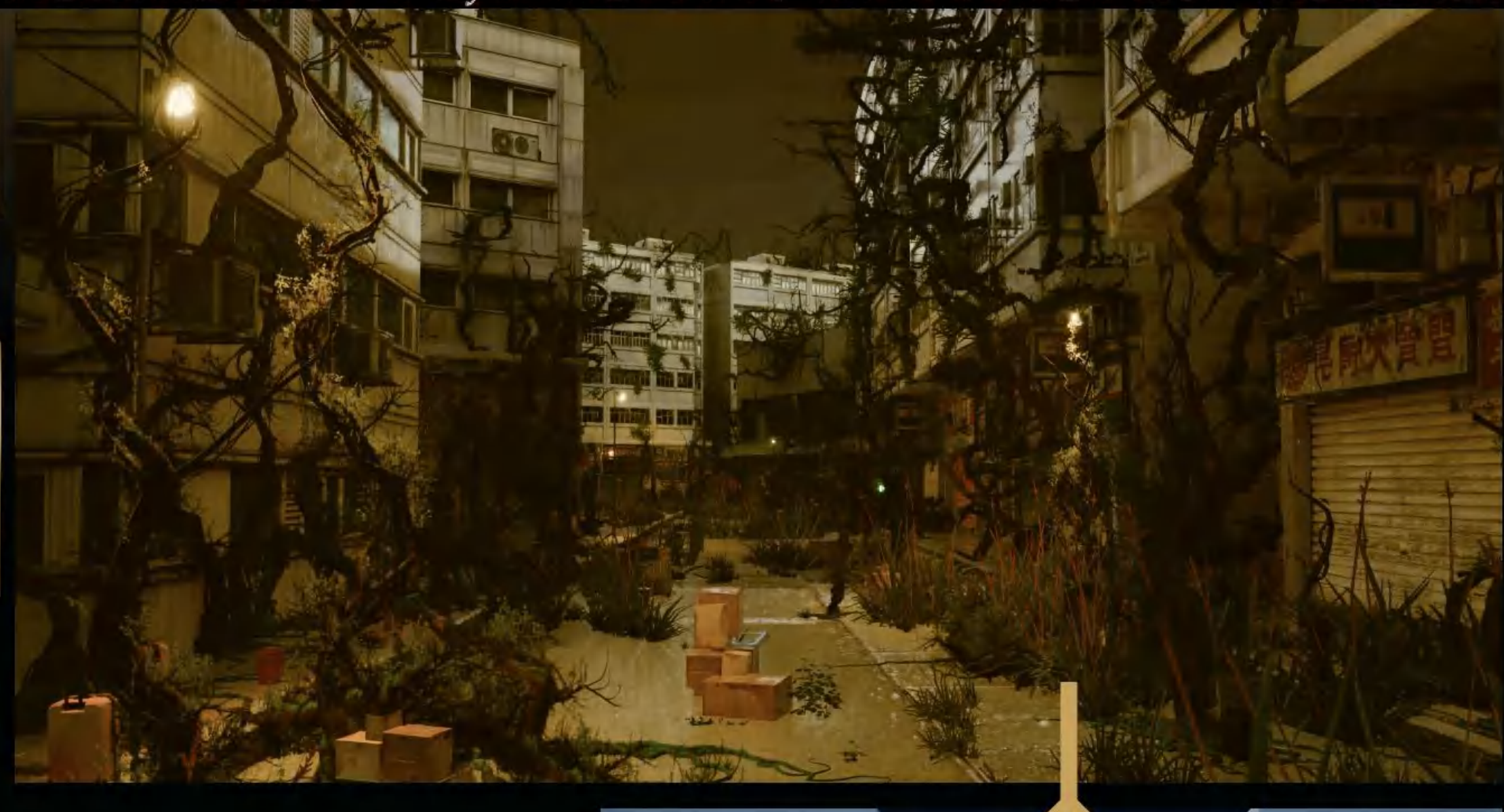
Potal Scene

The simple gray box prototype with a geometric arrow has evolved into a photorealistic, immersive scene featuring a post-apocalyptic ruin, a traditional Chinese archway, a glowing purple portal, and a colossal monstrous entity.





Pota2 Scene

The simple gray box geometric gray box evolved into a post-apocalyptic urban street overgrown with twisted vines and decaying buildings

SCENE DETAILS & GRAY BOX

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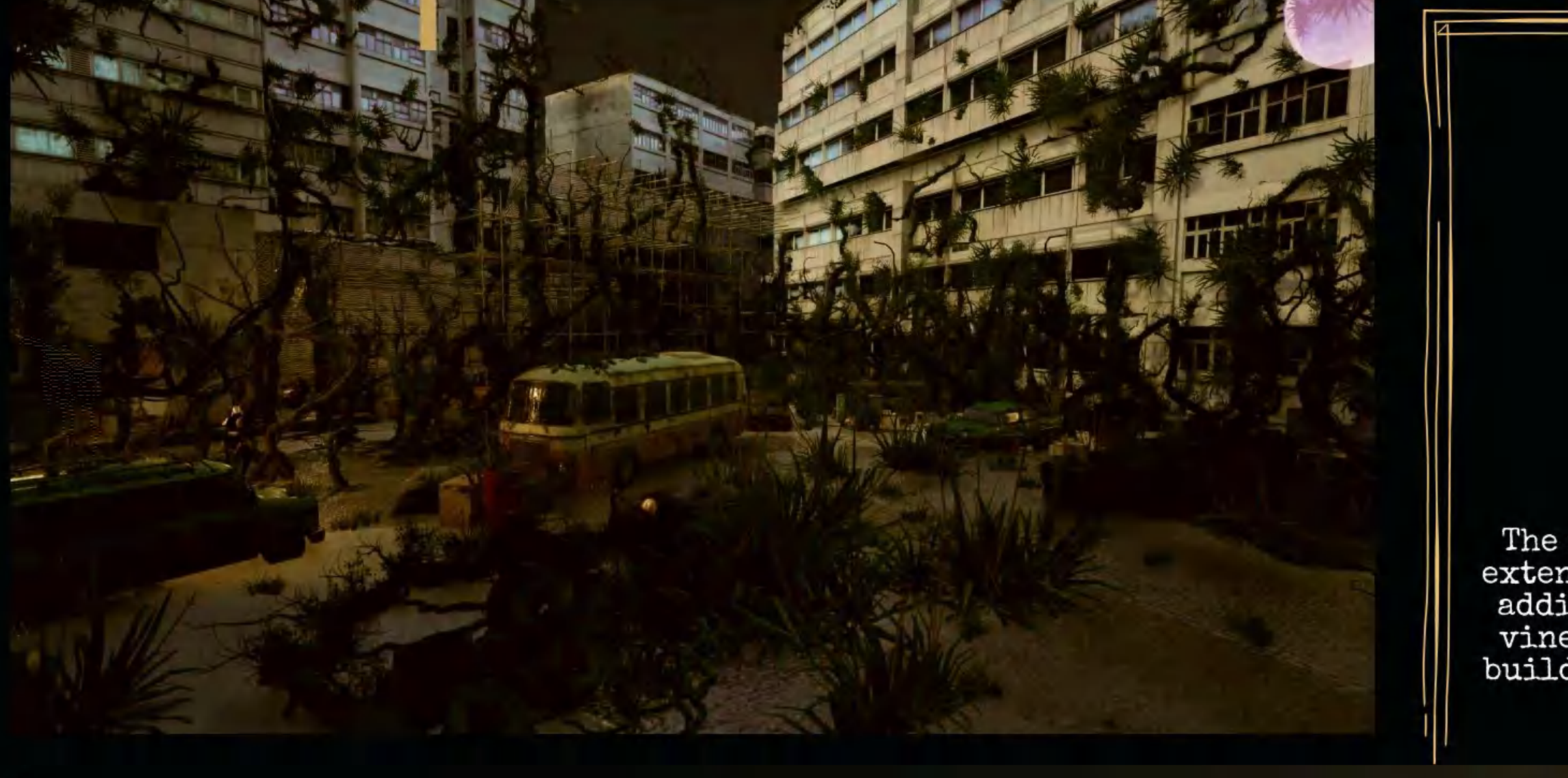
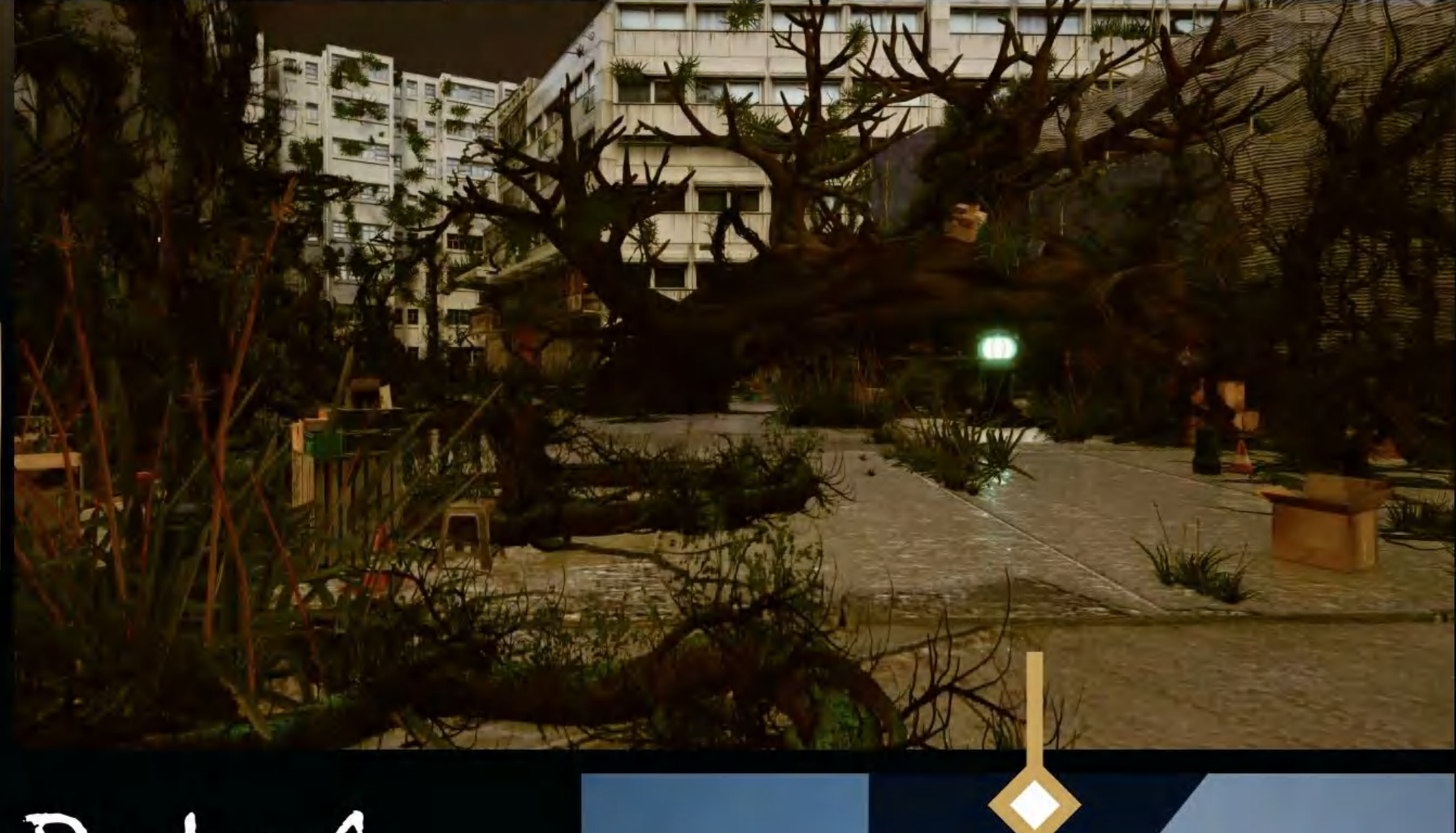
Pota3 Scene

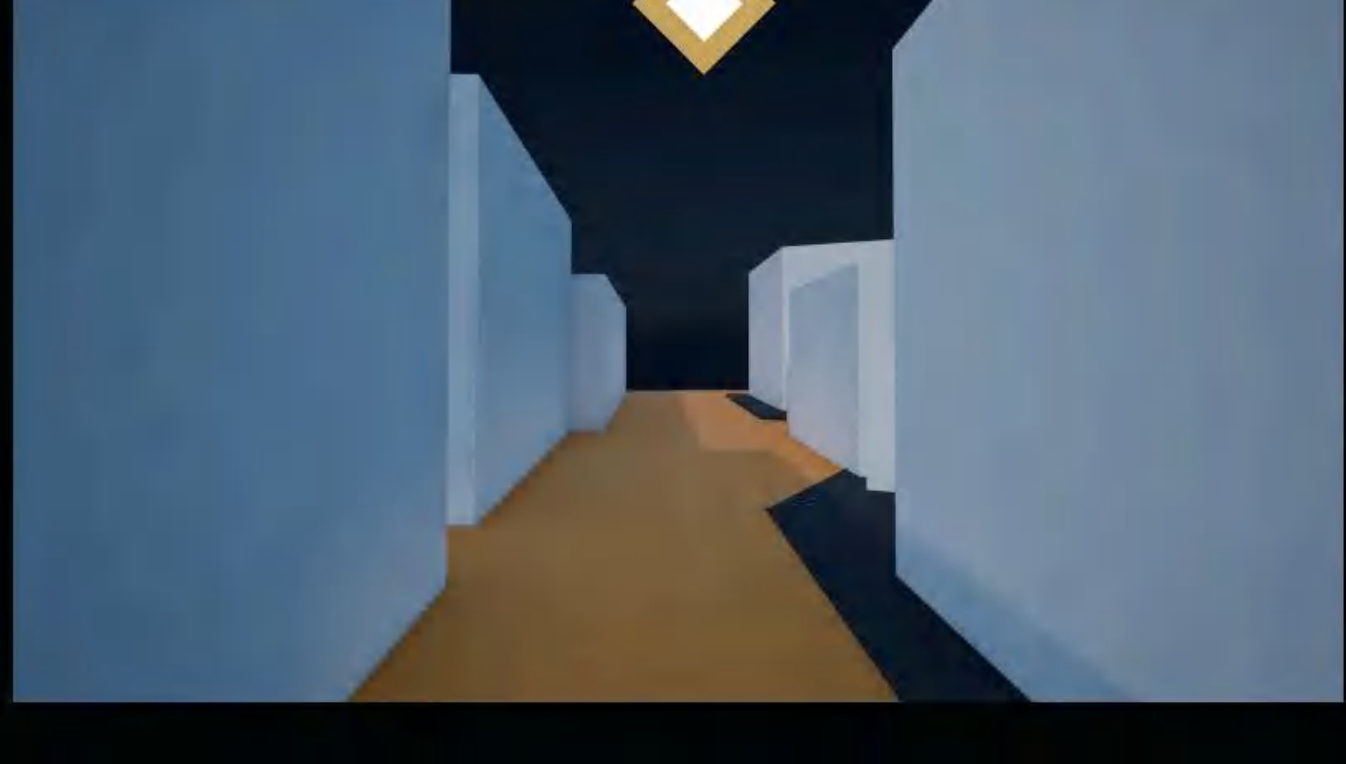
The minimal gray box prototype was extended into a photorealistic scene, adding an abandoned bus, overgrown vines, damaged pavement, and decaying residential buildings.



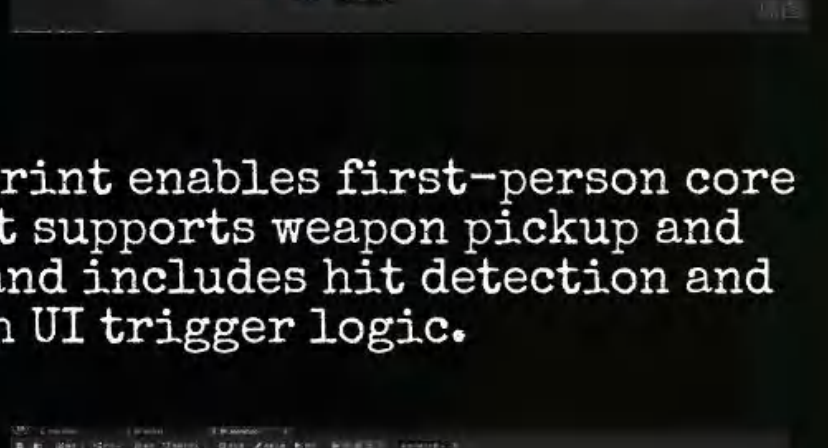


Pota4 Scene

The minimal gray box prototype was extended into a photorealistic scene, adding a giant dead tree, overgrown vines, damaged pavement, abandoned buildings, and scattered street light sources.

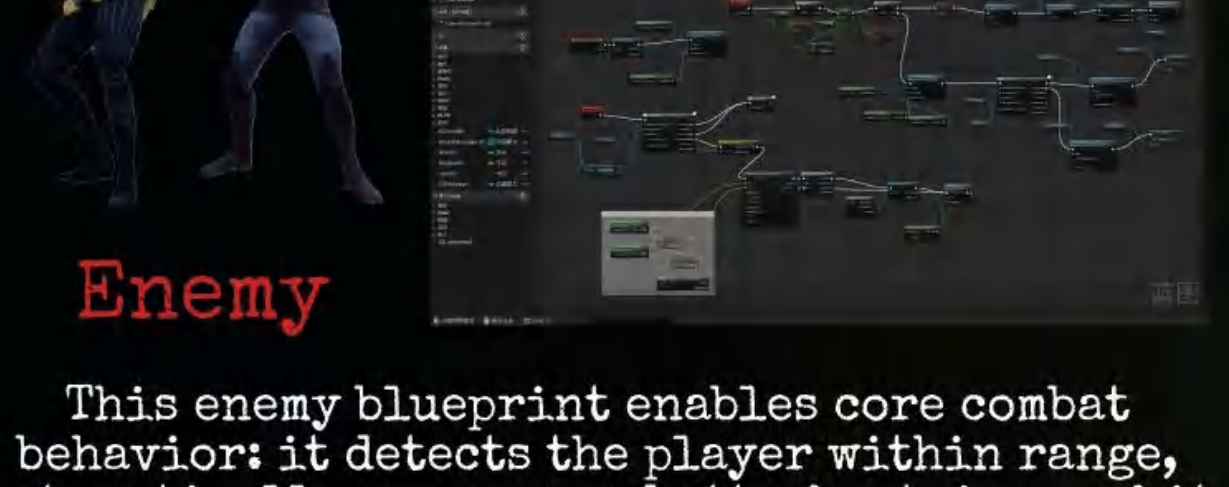


GAME BLUEPRINT



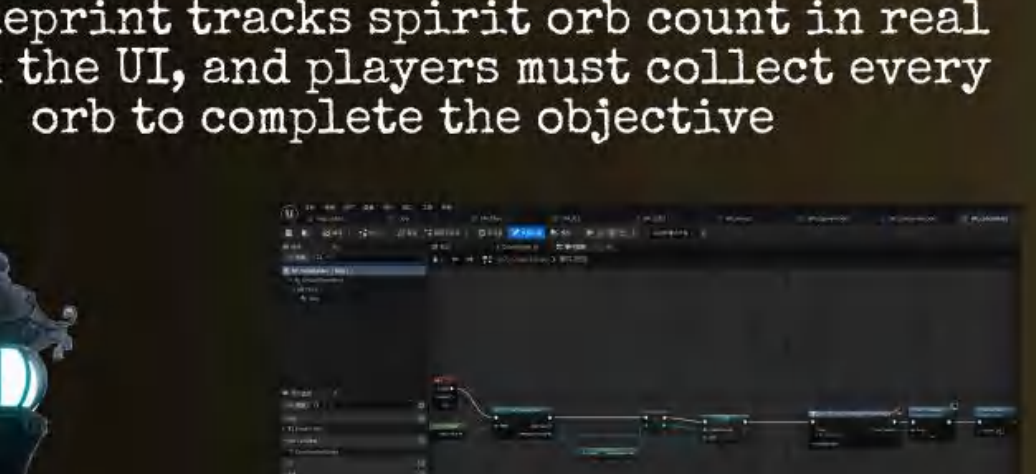
Player

This player blueprint enables first-person core interactions: it supports weapon pickup and firing actions, and includes hit detection and death UI trigger logic.



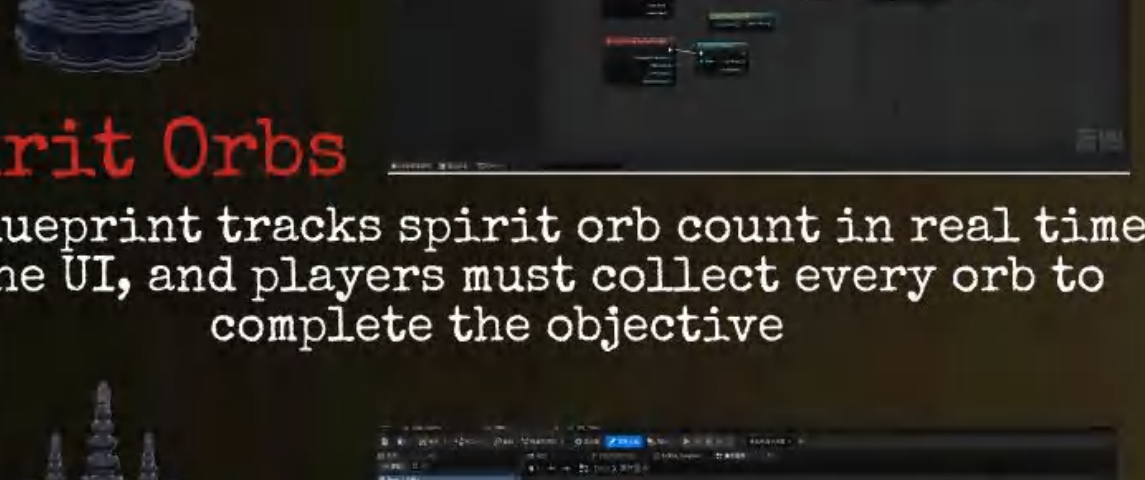
Enemy

This enemy blueprint enables core combat behavior: it detects the player within range, automatically pursues and attacks, triggers hit reactions when damaged, and plays death animations upon health depletion



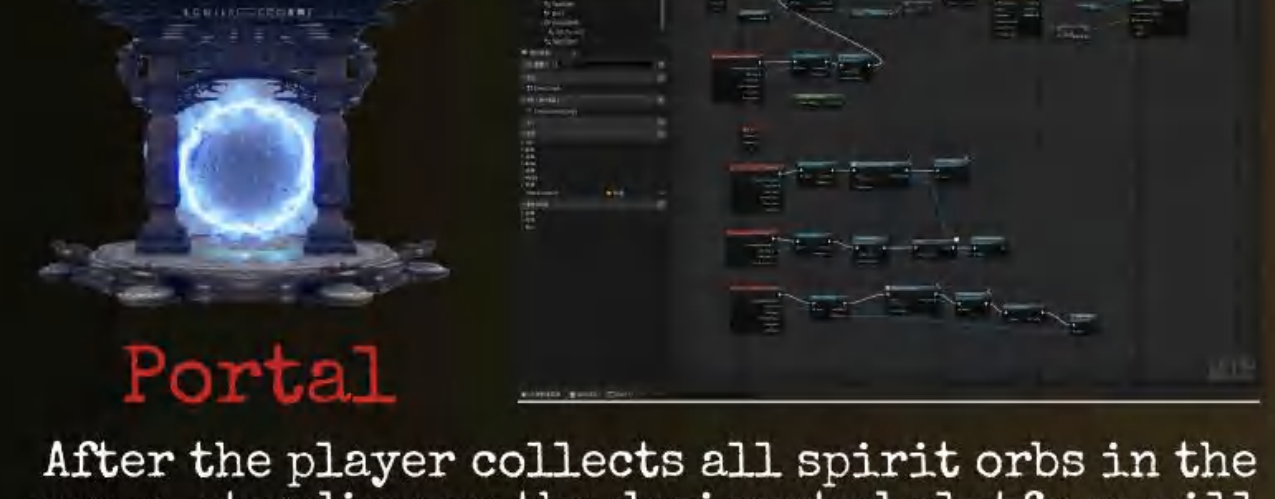
Weapon

The blueprint tracks spirit orb count in real time on the UI, and players must collect every orb to complete the objective



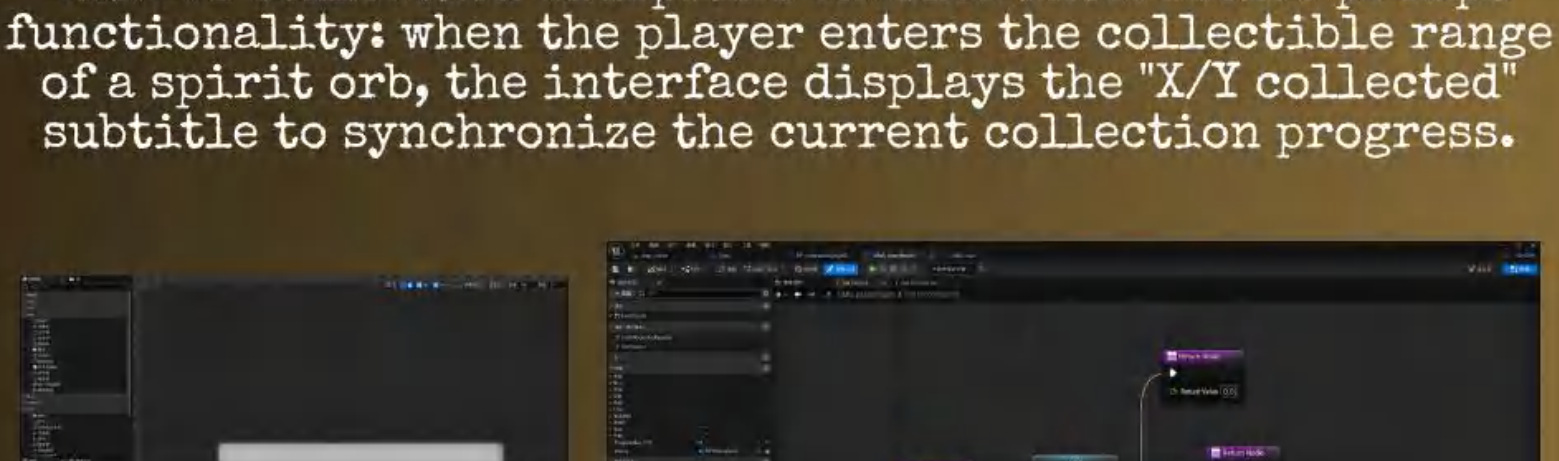
Spirit Orbs

The blueprint tracks spirit orb count in real time on the UI, and players must collect every orb to complete the objective



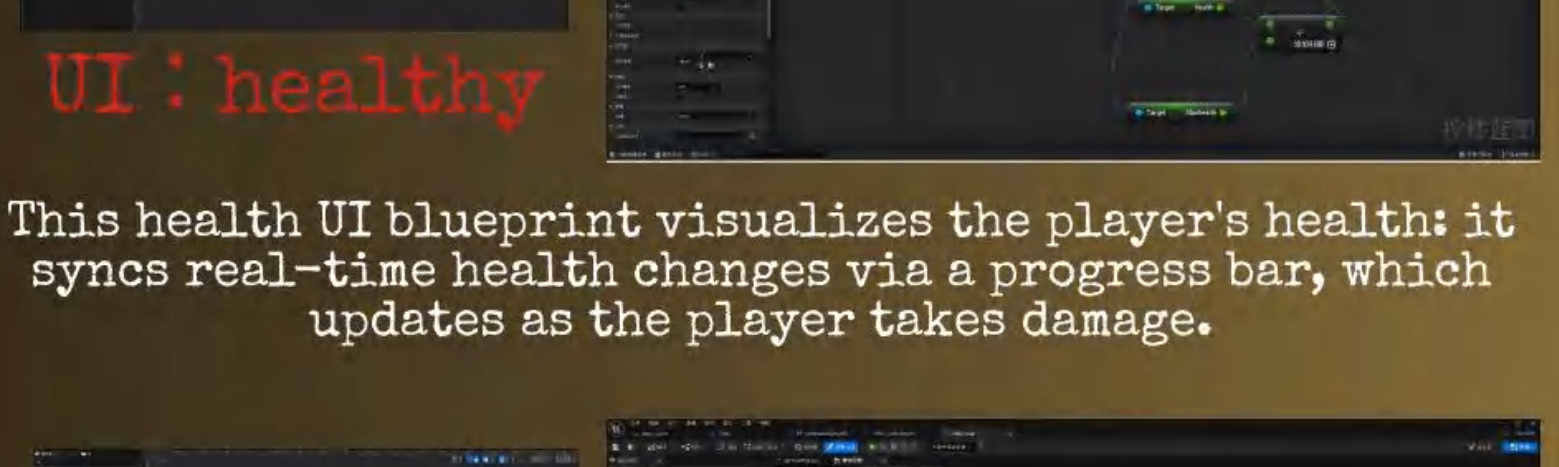
Portal

After the player collects all spirit orbs in the scene, standing on the designated platform will trigger the portal's rising interaction logic



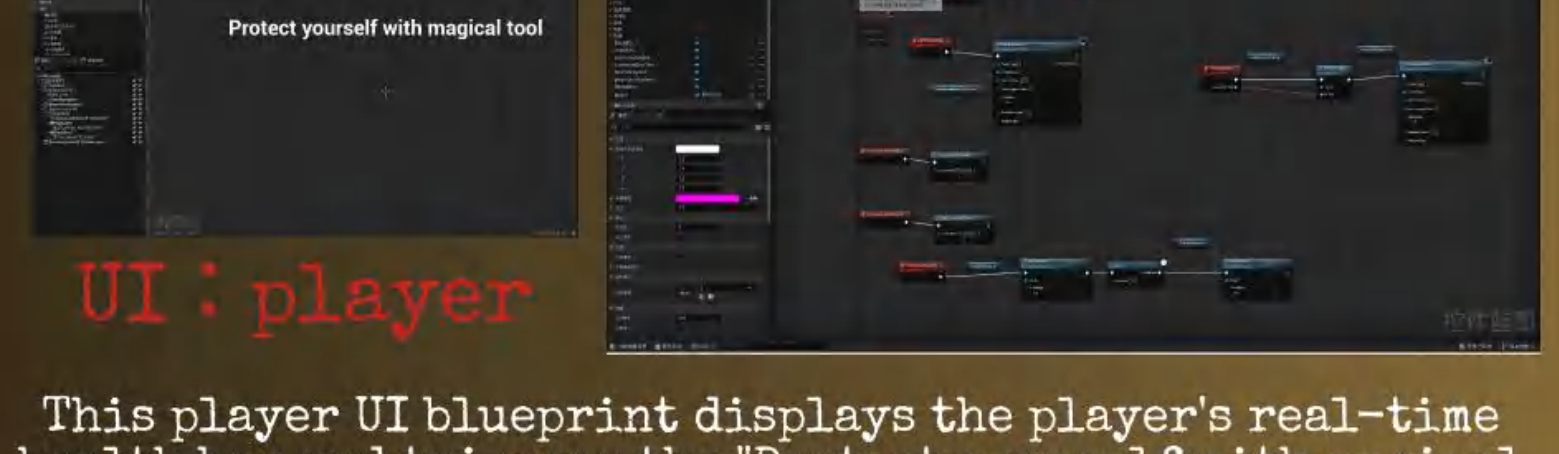
UI：collect

This UI collection blueprint enables interactive prompt functionality: when the player enters the collectible range of a spirit orb, the interface displays the "X/Y collected" subtitle to synchronize the current collection progress.



UI：healthy

This health UI blueprint visualizes the player's health: it syncs real-time health changes via a progress bar, which updates as the player takes damage.



UI：player

This player UI blueprint displays the player's real-time health bar and triggers the "Protect yourself with magical tool" subtitle when a weapon is picked up.